

JOEL STEPHEN

Full Stack Engineer · Frontend · AI · Backend

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SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5+ years building production software for B2B operational users — embedded with vendor, merchant, and admin user groups to translate ambiguous workflows into shipped product. Comfortable across Vue and TypeScript on the frontend, FastAPI + Python + GraphQL on the backend, and applied ML (YOLO v5, OpenCV) when the data justifies it. Currently shipping workflow features on Opus, AppliedAI's AI workflow platform. Based in Abu Dhabi; open to relocation across Southeast Asia.

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Engineer · AppliedAI

Jun 2025 — Present

Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Building production features on *Opus*, AppliedAI's core AI workflow platform that B2B customers use to automate operational business processes.
- Translating PM and designer requirements into reusable UI components and multi-step workflow layouts that end users operate on their own data with.
- Partnering with backend engineers to align the UI with underlying data pipelines so the product surfaces the right information at the right step in the user's workflow.
- Iterating on performance and UX based on real usage feedback and folding learnings back into the broader Opus product surface.
- Active in code review, sprint planning, and tight feature delivery in a small cross-functional team.

Senior Software Engineer · Otani Trading FZCO

Jul 2024 — Feb 2025

Dubai, UAE

- Led project direction and frontend delivery on a new PWA mobile application — owned requirements scoping, planning, and DevOps decisions end-to-end.
- Drove UI/UX directly in Figma with shadcn components, validating user workflows visually before committing backend investment.
- Made data-layer technology calls (URQL/GraphQL on the client, Strawberry + Python on the backend) to keep the pipeline stable and extensible for future feature work.
- Trained and mentored junior engineers so the team could continue shipping and operating the product independently.
- Embedded computer vision into the product where the data justified it — trained YOLO v5 models and used OpenCV for object detection and tracking.

Software Engineer · Otani Trading FZCO

Sep 2023 — Jul 2024

Dubai, UAE

- Embedded with vendor, merchant, and admin user groups on *Project FMI*, a large-scale B2B platform; shipped 7 major features and many smaller workflow improvements driven by direct user requirements.
- Built backend APIs (FastAPI + Pydantic + Peewee, and GraphQL with Strawberry + DynamoDB on *Project Valid*) and matching UI prototypes (VueJS, RadixVue, shadcn) so workflows were testable end-to-end

before going to users.

- Wrote end-to-end tests (Pytest, Cypress) to keep critical operational workflows safe for the users relying on them daily.
- Operated in pair-programming and agile sprints with continuous user feedback; mentored new joiners and handled merge/versioning across the team.

Junior Software Engineer · RIOT by Preowned Collective Portal FZ LLC

Sep 2019 — Feb 2023

Dubai, UAE

- Led implementation of cross-functional features on a customer-facing platform, including 3 payment gateways and multiple third-party integrations.
- Migrated data from a legacy platform to a new Node.js / ReactJS website — cutover from messy historic state to a clean operational pipeline.
- Automated operational tasks using Python scripting against internal and external APIs, freeing the ops team from repetitive manual work.
- Integrated Google Ads and Analytics so business stakeholders could make decisions on real user behaviour.
- Collaborated on requirement definition and prototyping with cross-functional teams using JIRA, Figma, GitHub, and Confluence.

SDE Intern · Alucor Limited

Jan 2019 — Jul 2019

Dubai, UAE

- Designed and shipped a Django web application to replace a critical Excel-based workflow.
- Built REST APIs, integrated LDAP authentication, and improved usability through event-driven front-end behaviour informed by direct user feedback.
- Used SQLAlchemy for the data layer and followed clean-coding standards (PEP8) with thorough documentation so the customer team could maintain the system after handover.

EDUCATION

B.E. Computer Science Engineering (Hons) · BITS Pilani Dubai Campus

Aug 2015 — Aug 2019

- Coursework: Object-Oriented Programming, Data Structures, Artificial Intelligence, Database Design.
- Capstone: TensorFlow / Python stock price prediction — full pipeline from data to model to operational signal.

SKILLS

Frontend: Vue 3, React, TypeScript, JavaScript, NuxtJS, RadixVue, shadcn, Zustand, HTML5, CSS, jQuery; Figma

Real-time & Collaborative: Yjs (CRDT), WebSocket, Server-Sent Events (SSE); multiplayer canvas surfaces with versioning

AI / LLM Engineering: Anthropic API, OpenAI API, custom AI pipelines, prompt engineering, RAG patterns; n8n (forked + extended for production workflow editing)

Advanced UI: Large-graph rendering, canvas performance, undo / redo correctness, virtualised lists, node-graph editors

Backend & APIs: Python (FastAPI, Django, Pydantic, Peewee), GraphQL (Strawberry, URQL), REST, SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, SQLAlchemy), PHP; limited DynamoDB

Applied ML & CV: YOLO v5 (training, production), OpenCV (object detection + tracking), TensorFlow (academic); legacy-to-new data migration

DevOps & Delivery: Hosting / CI-CD / monitoring ownership at project scale; Pytest, Cypress, Selenium; Git, GitLab, GitHub, Bitbucket; JIRA, Confluence, Postman; Kanban / Agile

Spoken Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (conversational), Malayalam (native, conversational)

Certifications: 16 listed on LinkedIn · AWS Cloud Practitioner (in progress)